

CAMBRIDGE HARKENER

CELEBRATING THE HERITAGE OF CAMBRIDGE, VERMONT

Vol. V, No. 1

Winter 2007

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Julie Brown, Ronnie Little,

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Advisory Board Members: Harold Putnam, Wendell Wells

2006 in Review

2006 was a year of firsts and a year of lasts.

We published our first book, *The Sugarhouses of Cambridge Vermont*,
compiled by Roberta Marsh and typeset by Ronnie Little.

We said a last goodbye to one of our Advisory Board members, Stub Wells.
This newsletter is dedicated to Stub, whose love for the Town of Cambridge
was unsurpassed.



January

Because of the cost of fuel, there was no meeting in January. For the same reason we opted out of participating in the annual Winterfest.

February

See January. February is short, but nasty. For that reason, we traditionally do not meet during the month

March

The Sugarhouses of Cambridge Vermont was published and put up for sale at Town Meeting. The 100 copies we had were sold out before lunch. A second printing was in order, then a third and a fourth. To date, the book has grossed over \$4,000.00. The March meeting was a viewing of the video *Life in Lamoille* which chronicles the way life was. Our own Ken Tobin was prominently featured in the video. Copies of both the book and the video are still available.

*The Sugarhouses of
Cambridge Vermont*



Then and Now

Completed and released
January 1998
Cambridge, Vermont

April

The April program was on the orphan trains that came to Vermont. The speaker, Dan Bean, is the son of one of those orphans and gave an interesting account of a subject about which many of us were ignorant. Discussions began on planning the History Expo exhibit and the Old Farm Days. More on both follows.

May

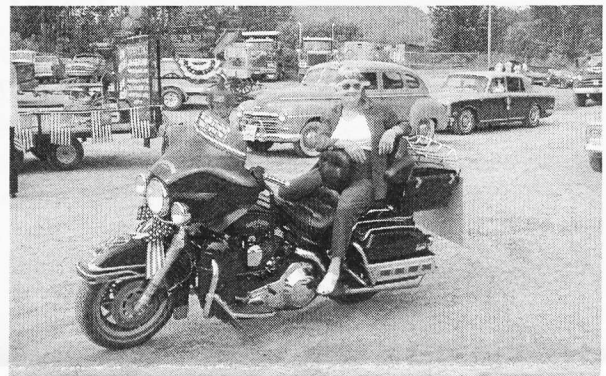
May was a busy month. The subject of the meeting was the Spruce Oil Mill given by Charles Tilton. It was an interesting and eye opening talk. Many had never realized that oil could be made and sold commercially from spruce trees.

On May 24th we held a dinner at the Smugglers Notch Inn. More tickets were sold than we had expected and it was tight quarters, but the food was good and the camaraderie was even better. We netted about \$1,000.00 from the evening. Thanks should go to the committee that put it all together, chaired by Natalie Deichmiller.

June

Once again CHS mounted an exhibit at the Vermont History Expo in Tunbridge. This year we decided to build on the success of Roberta Marsh's book and do the exhibit on sugaring. Gaylord and Barb Juell built a scale model of a sugarhouse complete with evaporator. Old sugaring equipment was on display as well as old sugarers (sorry Clark and Page) who added to the impact by recounting their experiences over the years. The sugarhouse model drew people into the booth and its fame spread throughout the Expo.

July



Miss Cambridge Historical Society
Photo by Bruce Maxfield

The big event in July was, of course, the 4th of July celebration. Marc Mallett drove his calliope in the parade with our banner prominently displayed. Miss Cambridge Historical Society rode a motorcycle and June Dodge and her tribe marched proudly. We had the museum open for the occasion and sold copies of Roberta's sugarhouse book and chances on the quilt donated to us by Martha Clifford. As usual, it was a good time for visiting as well as celebrating.

August

August was a month off. We needed to recuperate from June and July and store up energy for October.

September

At the business meeting it was announced that the society would be receiving two awards at the upcoming Meeting of the League of Local Historical Societies sponsored by the Vermont Historical Society. We were cited for Roberta's *Sugarhouses of Cambridge Vermont* and for the Sterling celebration put on by the towns of Johnson, Morristown, and Stowe as well as Cambridge. The program for the evening was originally going to be by Ken Tobin (see October, below) but instead was Jane Shaw talking about the history and acquisition of the Old Town Hall Building. This program was substituted at the last moment because of the timeliness of the subject (the Selectmen are thinking of selling it!)

October

The first weekend of October saw our annual Old Farm Days at the Dodge Homestead. Despite a rain-out on Sunday, we made over \$2,000.00 on the event. This event is a lot of work and the list of people to thank is too long for this newsletter - you know who you are and how much we all appreciate you. Our meeting saw the delayed talk by Ken Tobin on his family history.

November

November is our traditional Pot Luck month, and 2006 was no exception. Lots of food, lots of good conversation. . . no business or program.

December

We had our annual Christmas Yankee Swap in December. Roberta Marsh prepared a quiz for all to take and everyone brought cookies to share. Page Marsh's world famous maple fudge was the most sought after gift, with a nutcracker running a close second. Everyone enjoyed the event and left ready to face the holidays.



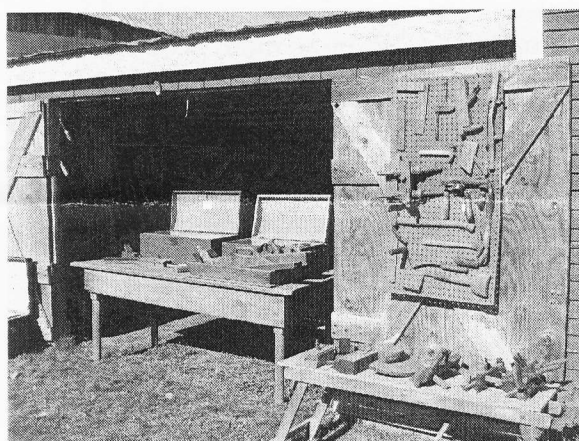
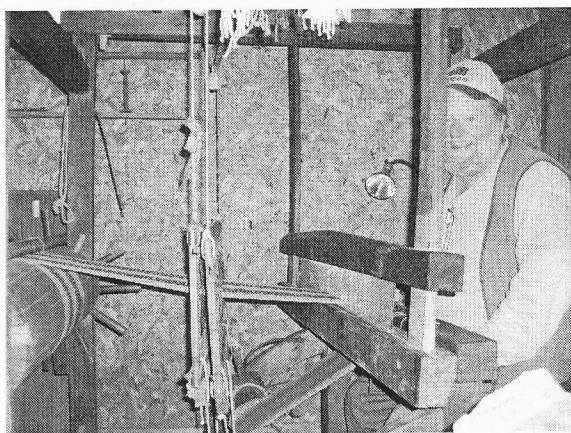
So ended another year at the Cambridge Historical Society. Attendance at meetings was usually in the 25-35 range - not bad for our small town. We hope more people will be able to come out for our 2007 meetings, which begin in March.

Please fill out the membership renewal form in this newsletter and return it with your dues. If you're a life member (and we have many) consider a small donation to the society to help pay the bills.

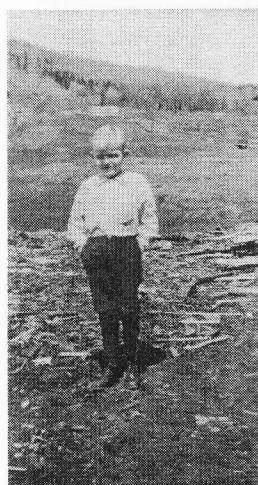
See you in March!!!



Some images of this year's Old Farm Days
courtesy of Hugh List



...and a final farewell to Stub



2007 Membership Application/Renewal

Please complete this form and mail to: Cambridge Historical Society
P.O. Box 16
Jeffersonville, Vt 05464

☐ New

☐ Renewal

Name _____

Address _____
Number Street Town State Zip

Phone _____ E-Mail _____

Membership Category

☐ Individual \$10.00

☐ Family \$15.00

☐ Business \$25.00

☐ Individual Life \$100.00

Please consider becoming a:

☐ Patron \$500.00

☐ Benefactor \$1000.00+

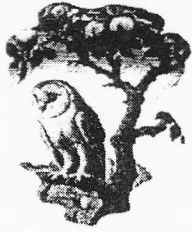
If you are a lifetime member you do not need to renew your membership.
However, if you wish to make a donation it would be much appreciated.

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If you have suggestions about program topics or have some great ideas for fundraisers,
please let us know by listing your ideas below.

RENEW YOUR MEMBERSHIP NOW!

Cambridge Historical Society
P. O. Box 16
Jeffersonville, VT 05464



The new year is here and it is time again to renew your membership in the Cambridge Historical Society. We've had a great year (*see inside*) with many interesting programs and wonderful events. This was accomplished through the physical and financial support of our many members and friends of the Society.

This newsletter and membership form is being sent to all members—lifetime and regular—plus other people who we feel might be interested. If you are a lifetime member, you do not need to renew your membership. However, if you wish to make a donation, it would be much appreciated.

We encourage and welcome all of you to join us as we embark on an exciting new year.

—Diancy Boyden, *Membership Chairman*

RENEW YOUR MEMBERSHIP NOW!